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Pollinating and connecting

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RIVERS OF CONVERSATIONS
RELATING SYSTEMS THINKING & DESIGN
RSD13 | OCTOBER 2024

Pollinating and Connecting: Mapping design-driven practices for inclusive and sustainable societal transformation

Ambra Trotto, Maria Claudia Coppola, and Caroline Hummels

The paper presents a mapping activity carried out in 2023 by a team of researchers from RISE Research Institutes of Sweden and the Eindhoven University of Technology (EIT) as part of an assignment from EIT Culture & Creativity. The mapping aimed to map design-driven Practices for Inclusive and Sustainable Societal Transformation.

It stems from the need, voiced by professionals in the field from various organisations, to better understand how to face complex systemic challenges in an inclusive and collaborative way, leveraging design and creative practices.

Building on the team's design expertise rooted in the body of knowledge of Design for Transforming Practices, the mapping investigates the playfield of achieving a sustainable societal transformation, carving out what design practices are currently invited into it and how they are enacted through multi- and inter-disciplinary partnerships.

Given the complexity of the playing field, the mapping takes an iterative, participatory, and reflective stance, making space for participants' plurality of approaches and questions, and fostering collective resonance. As a result, the mapping portrays a multi-layered landscape, exploring the values and qualities behind organisational and collaborative models that enable conditions for ecosystemic practices of transformation, leveraging culture and creativity to unfold.

This contributed to the co-formulation of recommendations for and from the sector. The recommendations address partners of the EIT Culture & Creativity, stakeholders working in the cultural and creative sector, and societal actors engaged in mission-driven innovation. They offer insights that facilitate access to available strategic design and creative expertise.

KEYWORDS: design for societal transformation, complex, complexity, interdependence, participatory processes, collective sensemaking, learning

RSD TOPIC(S): Economics & Organisations, Learning & Education, Mapping & Modelling, Methods & Methodology

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1 Approaching the context: fuelling culture and creativity

The ongoing social, economic, and environmental crises urgently demand systemic transformations to ensure thriving together on our planet (Meadows, 2015; Williams et al., 2017; Russel, 2013; Laszlo, 2019). The interconnectedness that is inherent to both systems and crises (Lawrence et al., 2024) calls for ways to enter complex, multi-stakeholder environments, break disciplinary siloes, and weave trans-sectoral, public-private partnerships (Mazzucato, 2021). Recent European initiatives—such as the New European Bauhaus (2020) and the formalisation of EIT Culture & Creativity in 2022—are an institutional acknowledgement of the potential of cultural and creative practices to bridge disciplinary divides, especially considering the mission-oriented innovation framework (Hill, 2022).

The emphasis on cultural and creative sectors and industries (CCSIs) is strategic, as they can shape socio-material arrangements that challenge and reframe current norms across various domains—such as leisure, mobility, health, and policy- and have an inherently transformative nature and power. CCSIs can also facilitate a new kind of knowledge exchange across disciplinary and sectoral boundaries. This is a challenge to institutions and supporting infrastructures, which are in need of harvesting knowledge on how cultural and creative people and organisations work with(in) complexity to provide them with more effective value-creation spaces, processes, and models.

Particularly, the paper aims at nurturing a widespread literacy *about* and *for* currently available design expertise, presenting a mapping activity carried out in 2023 by researchers working on a strategic group initiated by EIT Culture & Creativity on the topic of "Design for Inclusive and Sustainable Societal Transformation" - led by the Eindhoven University of Technology, RISE Research institutes of Sweden and d.centre|EU, a European movement that acts as a community of practice and learning using aesthetics and creative powers as wedges for a regenerative transformation (https://dcentre.eu/). This movement interweaves changemakers' experience and competencies to create an extensive body of knowledge (e.g. Trotto et al., 2021; Hummels, 2021; Hummels et al., 2018).

The paper first introduces how the mapping has been designed and what the process looked like. It then discusses the collaborative sensemaking process and its results, including recommendations for EIT Culture & Creativity about how to support the field's development. The paper concludes with a reflection on the process, focusing on the encountered frictions and learnings.

2 Framing the lenses informing the mapping activity

EIT Culture & Creativity is a funding and innovation agency supported by the European Institute of Innovation and Technology, a body of the European Union. EIT Culture & Creativity co-finances long-term partnerships with a return on investment and a transformative purpose to increase resilience in and by the cultural and creative sector and industry (CCSI).

EIT Culture & Creativity launched ten mapping activities carried out in ten Action Programs connected to specific strategic objectives in early 2023. These mapping activities were the first actions of EIT Culture & Creativity, aiming to provide a comprehensive snapshot of Europe's cultural ecosystem to strengthen and transform Europe's cultural and creative sectors and Industries (CCSI) by connecting creatives and organisations to Europe's largest innovation network.

The presented mapping activity, "Design-Driven Practices for Inclusive and Sustainable Societal Transformation," aimed to harvest knowledge on how cultural and creative

people and organisations work in multistakeholder environments to achieve inclusive, sustainable societal transformation, leveraging design-driven expertise.

Building on the research team's systemic perspective and theoretical embedding in pragmatic and ecological philosophies (encapsulated in d.centre|EU), the mapping focuses on *practices*[1] as in "temporary, yet relatively steady, ways of living and working with others" (Wittgenstein in Hummels, 2021), unfolding in the sensible layer of everyday life. The focus on practices offers the possibility to keep a dialogic relationship between the bigger scope of living, namely the aspirations and desirable values, and the creation and appropriation of designed socio-material arrangements and artefacts.

The mapping collects and highlights the processes and practices enacted by pathfinders of change, namely people coming from all corners of society—academia, industry, public bodies, and semi-public initiatives—and working with(in) the cultural and creative sector on transformation. As a result, the mapping activity aims at carving out what design for societal transformation is, which values are pursued, through which qualities, and how people relate to those values and qualities in their practices; it aims at looking into the playfield of design for inclusive and sustainable societal transformation, exploring what it looks like and what practices are currently invited in it.

3 Process: a set of design-infused endeavours

The mapping activity is connected to a broader set of design-infused activities carried out by d.centre|EU to develop the EU Design Agenda and to operationalise the area of Design for Inclusive and Sustainable Societal Transformation within the EIT Culture & Creativity ecosystem. The agenda development process has involved more than 400 people and 180 organisations in various activities: working sessions and hands-on workshops with the EIT Culture & Creativity and coordinators, the Swedish NEB network, researchers, and experts working in the field of societal transformation in Europe. These activities resulted in a list of interested partners, activating a number of

[1] Within practices "human activities are inextricably interwoven with material arrangements—in particular people, artefacts, organisms and nature —, and which are informed by roughly defined aspirations, certain "rules" and specific ethics and values, which in its turn will be asking again for adjustments of arrangements and activities" (Hummels, 2021).

loops of engagement, namely interactions among potential mapping participants, coming from networks not directly connected to the research team (Figure 1).

Transformation and transformative practices operate within multi-layered, transdisciplinary, and dynamic dimensions, inviting an open-ended stance while taking a snapshot of the current state of the art. This called for a designerly approach to the mapping, which resulted in an iterative, participatory, and reflective process.

Particularly, it has been structured as follows:

STEP 1: Engaging builds on events previously run by the research team, which raise awareness on design, transformation, and transformation through design. Here, a list of interested participants has been invited to an Information Meeting, conceived as a moment of first engagement and action. Through the Information meeting, participants got to know each other and were introduced to the ongoing work on design for inclusive, sustainable societal transformation, the research team, its mapping activity, and, ultimately, its broader connection to feeding the EIT Culture & Creativity work.

STEP 2: Collecting consisted of gathering information from and about interested participants through different capturing tools: a survey collecting quantitative and qualitative data, and designed visuals. With its 44 questions, the survey was the core information-collecting tool (see Figure 3).

Completed by 47 participants, it collected information about their practices, including projects, networks, building principles, values, and qualities of working together to achieve transformation.

STEP 3: Sensemaking embodied the core phase of the mapping process, presenting the need for different methodologies to handle the nature of captured data. The hybrid dataset—both quantitative and qualitative—resulting from the survey called for a careful selection of processing tools to preserve nuances and discrepancies in responses (see Figure 4).

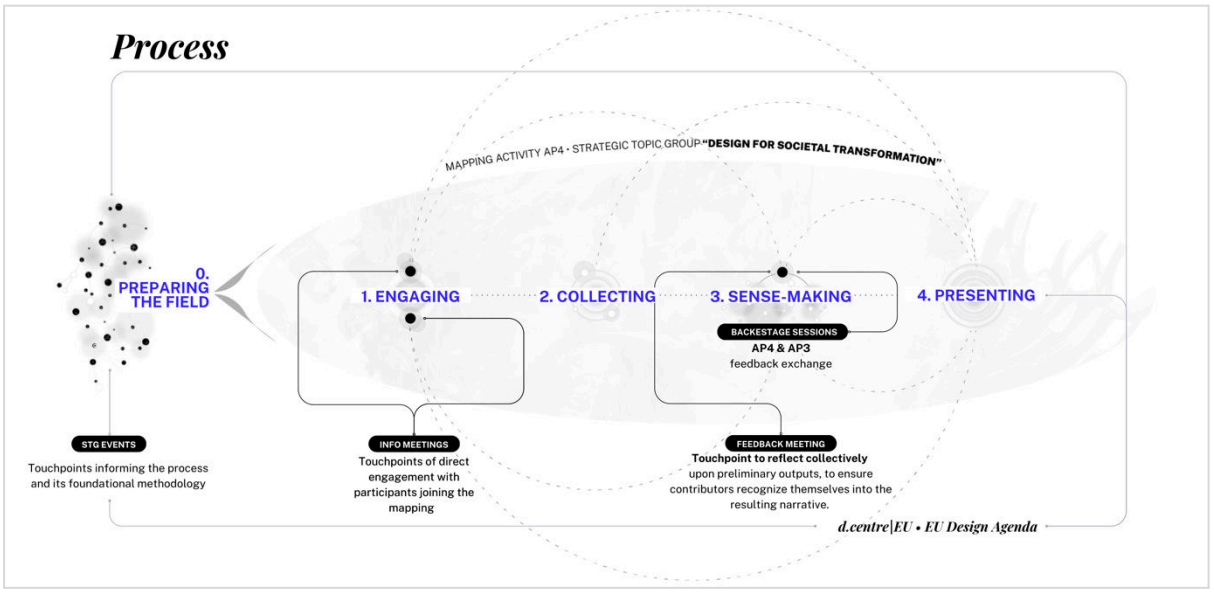


Figure 1. Overview of the relationship between the agenda-setting process. Preparing the field and the mapping activity.

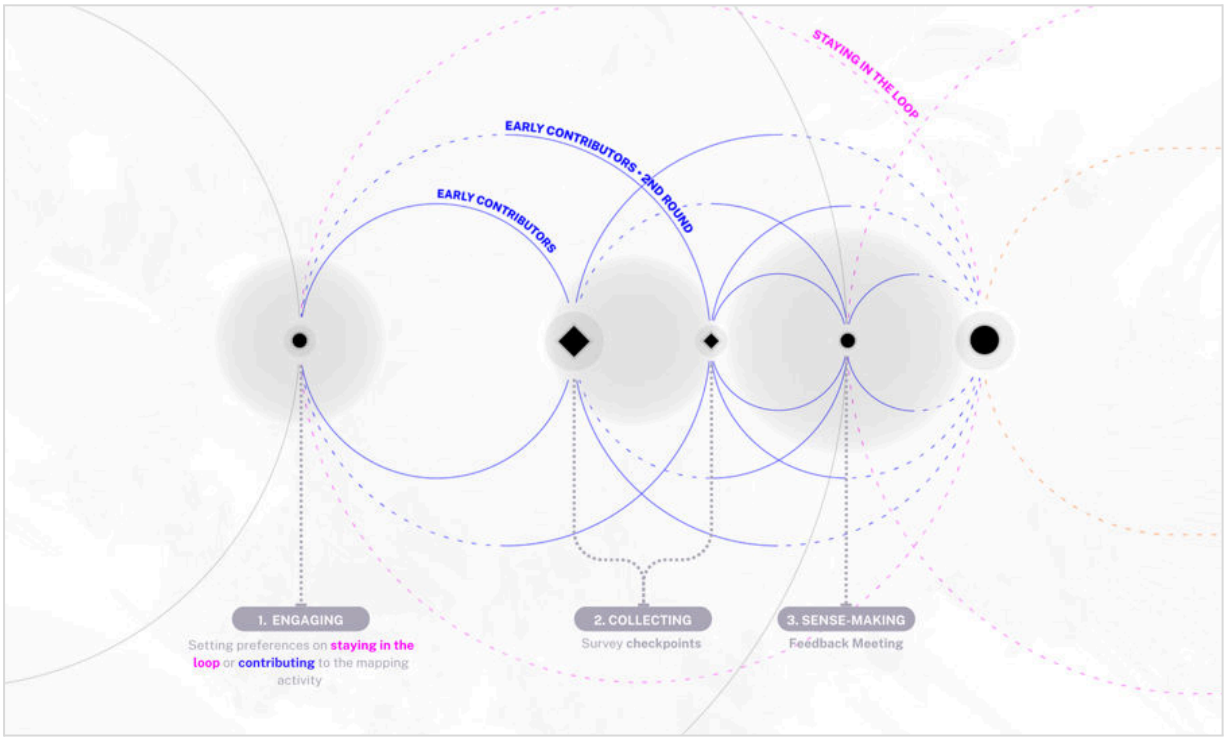


Figure 2. Visualisation of loops of engagement started while running the mapping activity.

Figure 4 shows that the final sensemaking process relied mainly on frequency and thematic analysis to look for recurring keywords and patterns. During this phase, the first AI-assisted iteration was conducted, supported by data visualisation tools. As Figure 5 shows, we worked along a highly iterative and engaging process to address the biases and limitations connected to AI's "black box" in a participated way. In fact, the sensemaking backstage has been tied to a moment for collective reflection, which would open up the process, invite feedback into partially processed content and shape it as the result of collective effort. This allowed participants to recognise themselves in the final, emerging narrative.

Along with the analytical approach, the sensemaking process was infused with a design-based workshop to provide participants with tools highlighting key themes calling for further development. As such, participants met on shared online boards, where content from the survey was presented, inviting dialogue amongst the participants to further develop the breadth and depth of the content.

STEP 4: Presenting and discussing is the last step of the process, constituting the finalisation of mapped content and formulation of a set of recommendations to be further presented and discussed within the EIT Culture & Creativity.

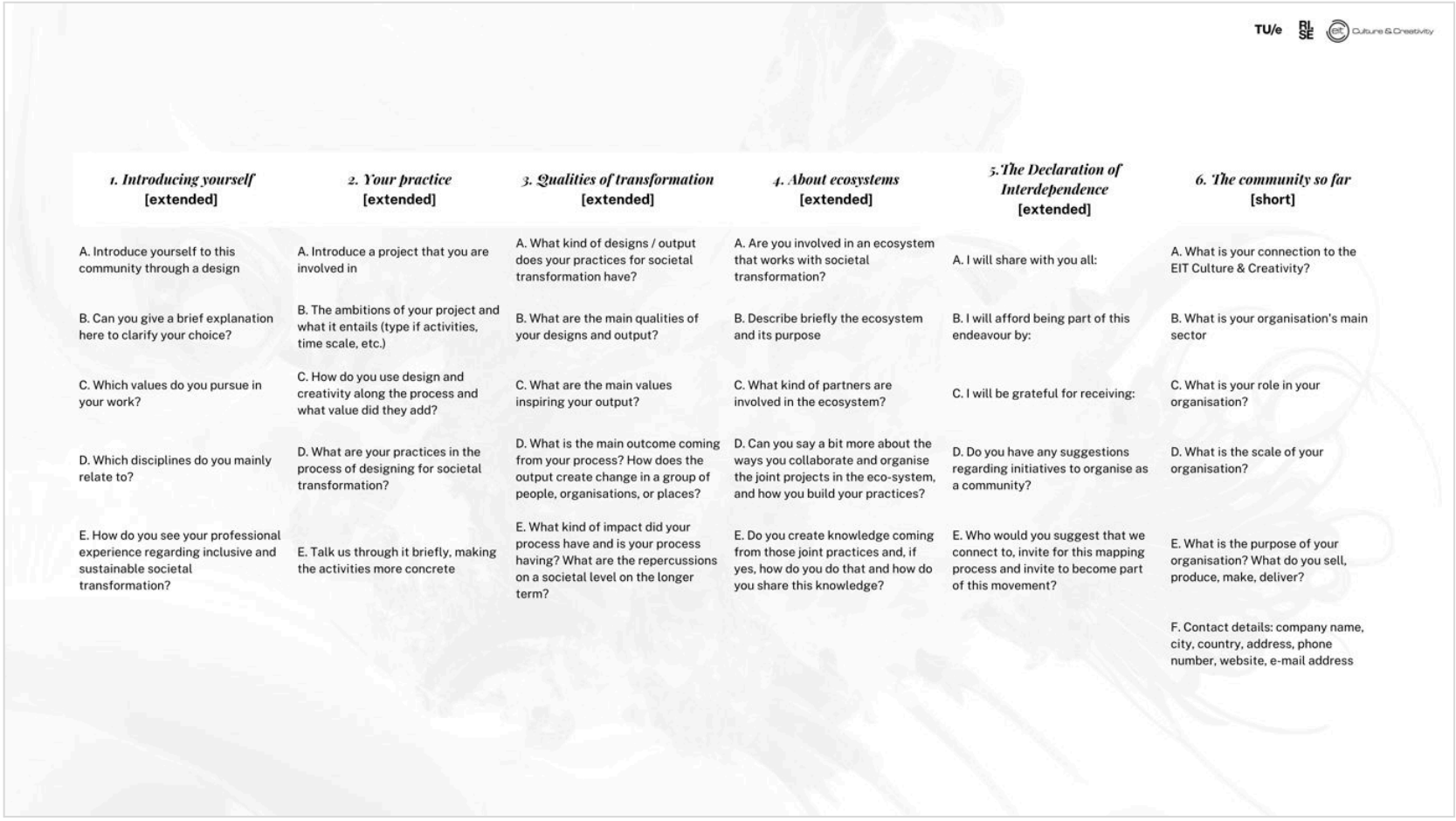


Figure 3. List of survey questions organised by sections 1–6.

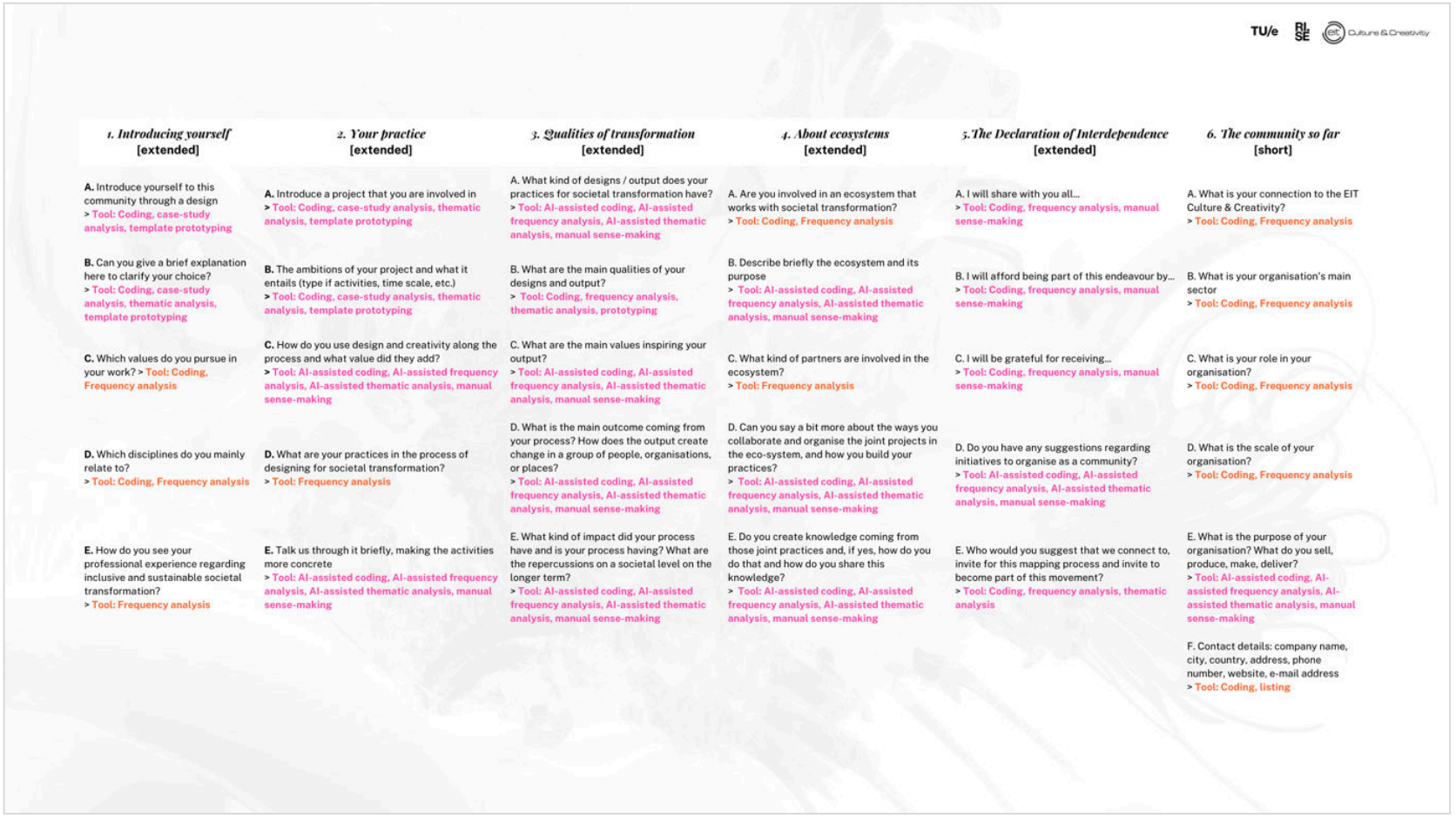


Figure 4. Quantitative (orange) and qualitative (pink) tools and approaches paired to questions.



Figure 5. Visualisation of the two sensemaking rounds:
first, the backstage one (processed data), then the collective and opened-up one (finalised data).

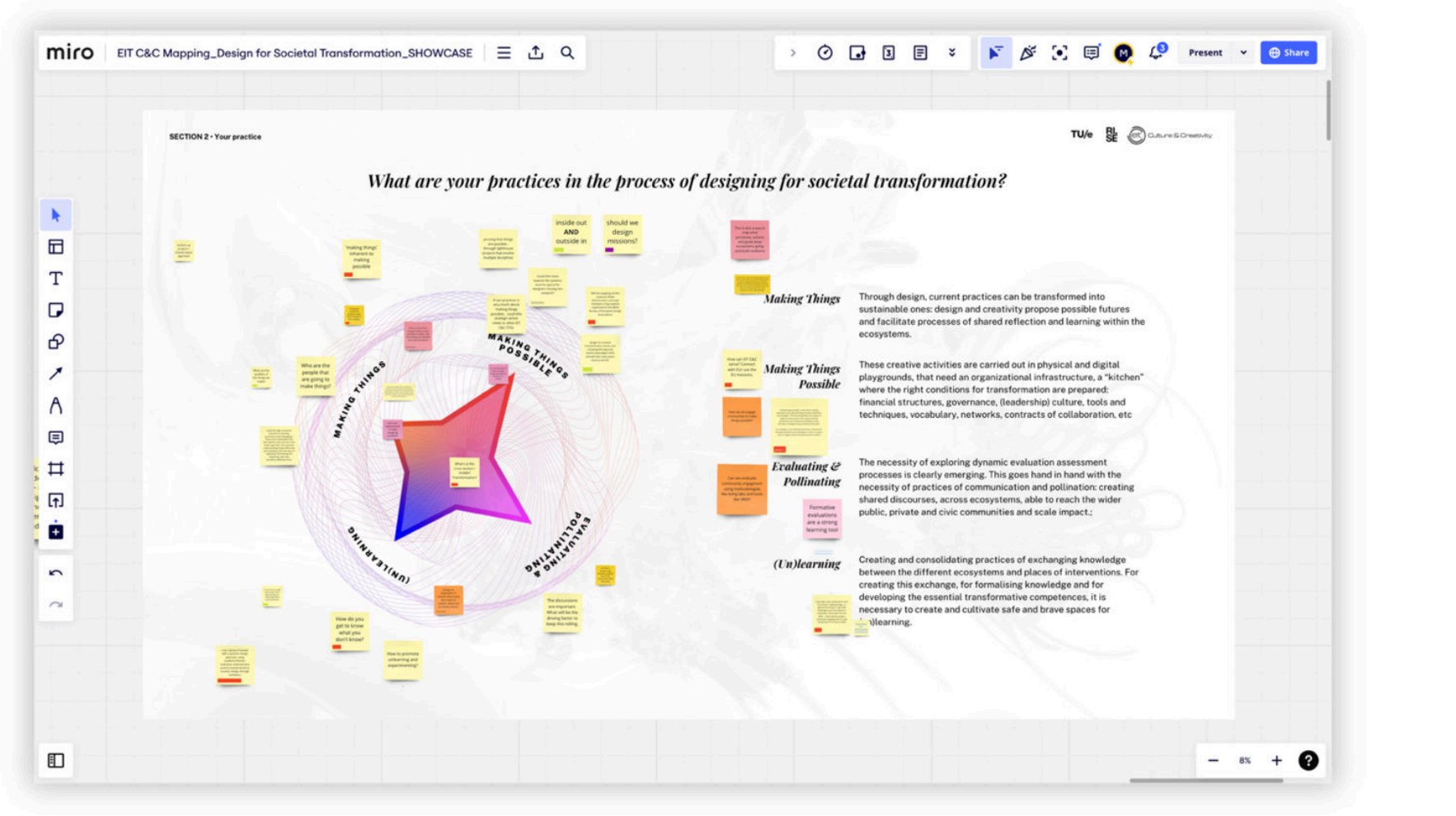


Figure 6. Screenshot from the Feedback Meeting held with participants to dive into key content emerging from preliminary sensemaking steps.

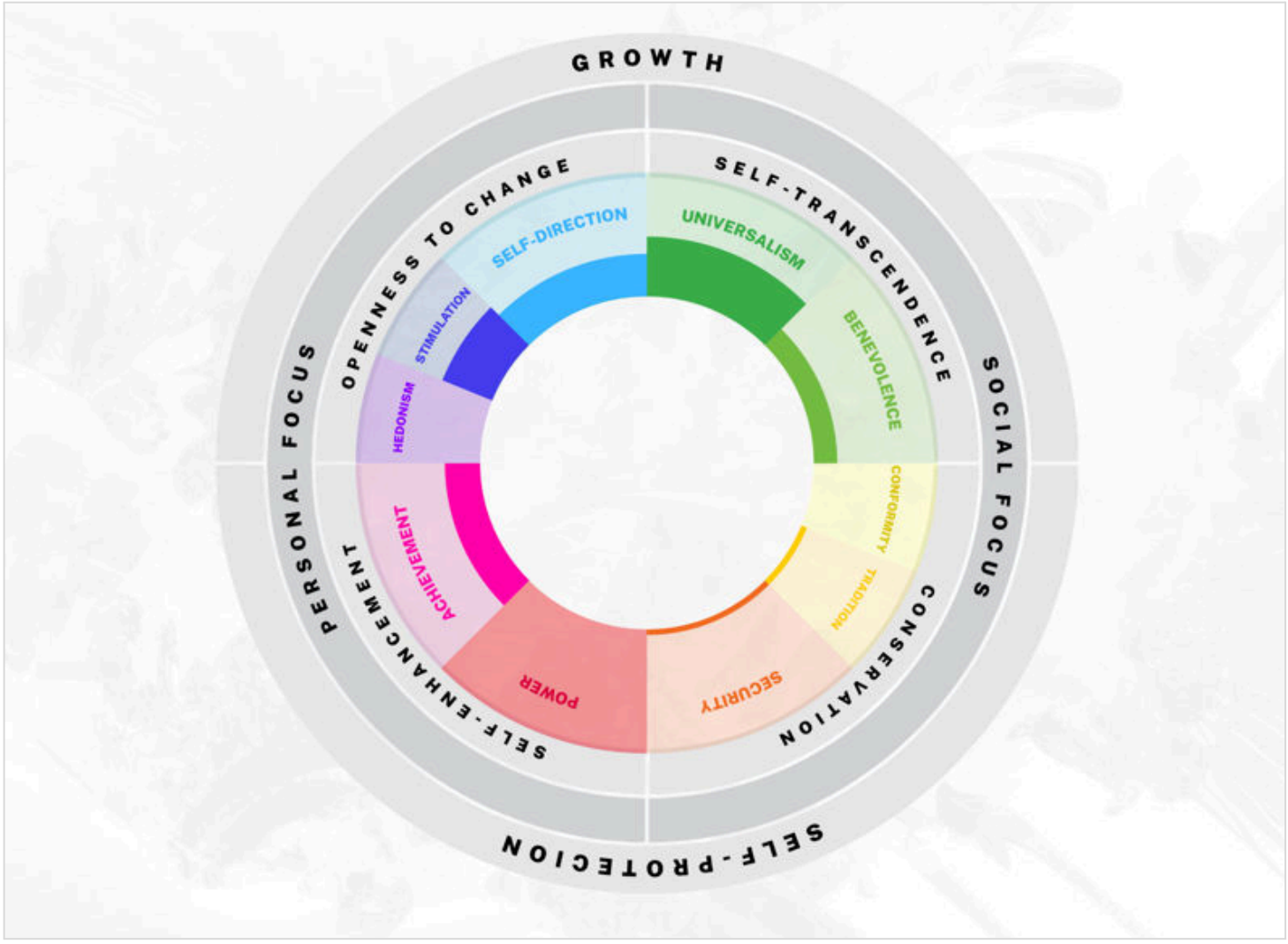


Figure 7. First-person perspective matters, pursued in participants' work. Based on Schwartz's (2006) work



Figure 8. A word cloud represents the spread of the disciplines participants mostly relate to.



Figure 9. A sample of the portfolio of collected cases, redacted into templates.

4 Mapping results overview

Results from the mapping activity have been collected in an online report containing interactive visualisations, in-depth analysis, and detailed insights. This paper will provide the reader with an overview of the main results, presenting them along the six survey sections (see Figure 3).

SECTION 1: Introducing yourself

This section explored participants' first-person perspective matters, like the values in Figure 7. Values pursued in participants' work are based on Schwartz's (2006) work. The darker colours represent the answers of the participants pursued in their work, the disciplines they related to, and their connection to contributing to the triple transformation. Based on Schwartz's (2006) work on human basic values, responses to the first question portray a community of pathfinders of change recognising universalism and benevolence as the main drivers of their practices, paired with the need for stimulation and express self-direction towards achievement.

The tendency towards self-transcendence speaks of attitudes questioning beliefs for collective well-being. Additionally, collective growth is fostered by openness to change from a personal perspective, emphasising stimulation and self-direction. The pursuit of self-enhancement through achievement reflects an acknowledgement of personal agency and commitment to tradition while seeking safety, harmony, and stable relationships, underscoring the importance of security while working towards the triple transformation.

As for the disciplines that participants relate to (Figure 8), even if there is a slight turn towards design, the mapping activity represents a wide range of disciplines working on triple transformation: areas like transition studies and environmental studies have been cited by participants, strengthening the trans-and multi-disciplinary feature of transforming endeavours led by this community.

SECTION 2: Your practice

This section is aimed at collecting information on concrete practices carried out to achieve triple transformation. The 40 practices collected have been submitted to a first round of sensemaking, to draw out common coordinates and draft a portfolio of

transformation practices (Figure 9). Over time, these practices will be shared via the d.centre|EU website (https://dcentre.eu/).

After asking participants to give inputs on their practices, we designed a set of tags and a template to organise the collected content. The resulting portfolio shows a slight majority in knowledge-based outputs—methodologies and tools, theories and principles—and a slight tendency to contribute to transformation through immaterial outputs—organisational models, business models, and policies—over tangible ones—artefacts and product-service systems.

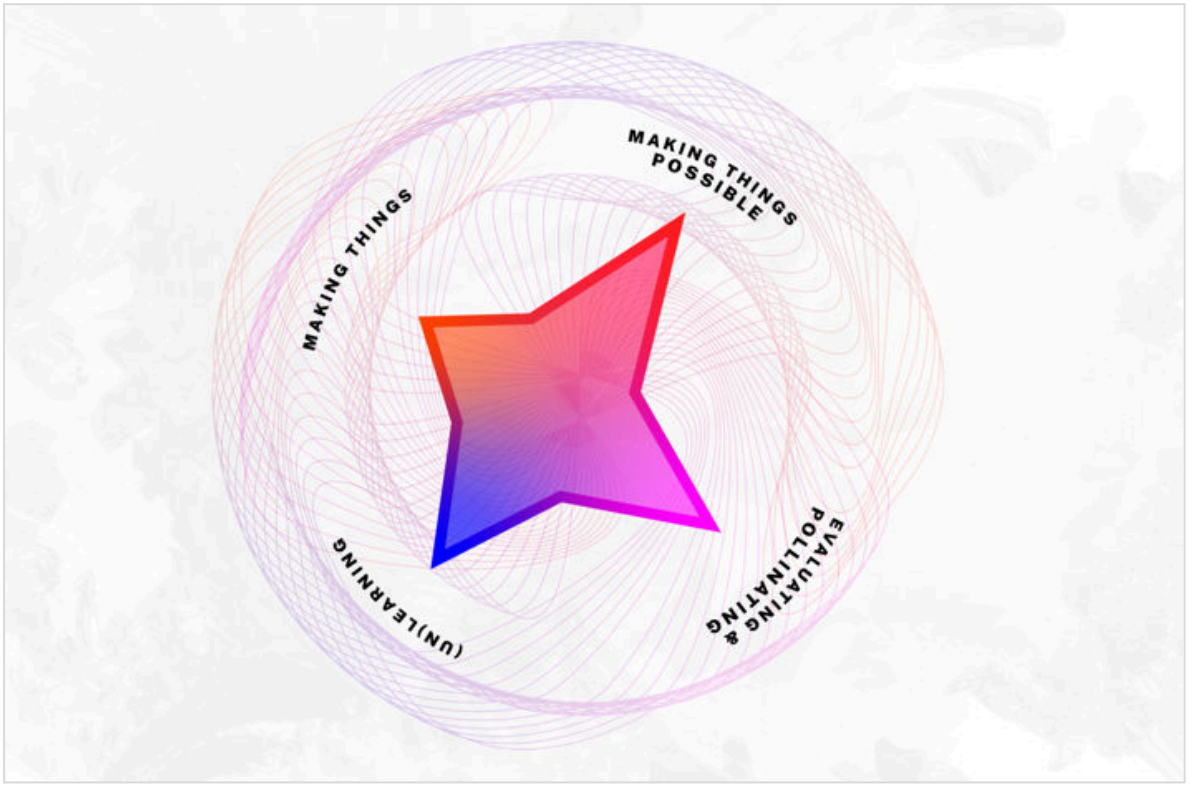


Figure 10. Participants indicate which practices are incorporated in their activities of designing for societal transformation.

Furthermore, we collected the following set of key themes that the participants considered to be the added value of design and creativity in their practices:

- Tapping into aesthetics, interaction, and embodiment.
- facilitating co-creation;
- eliciting inter-disciplinary sensemaking and learning;
- disrupting conventional thinking patterns and experimenting.

Lastly, participants were asked to frame their practices along the four processes of working towards transformation. These processes are captured in the model of d.centre|EU (Trotto & Hummels, 2023), presented and iterated since the early drafts of the EU Design Agenda for Inclusive and Sustainable Societal Transformation.

“MAKING THINGS POSSIBLE” (29 cases connected) ranks as the most-rated process. This indicates that most participants are prioritising (infra)structures and conditions to realise transformation. Such activities are carried out in physical and digital playgrounds that need an organisational infrastructure, a so-called “kitchen” (after Ingold (2011) and Wakkary (2021), where the right conditions for transformation are prepared: financial structures, governance, (leadership) culture, tools and techniques, vocabulary, networks, contracts of collaboration etc... “EVALUATING AND POLLINATING” (26 cases) and “(UN)LEARNING” (24 cases) come next, suggesting they are soft spots in transformative ecosystems. The even spread of processes led to the need to look for further insights, inviting participants to discuss this visualisation in the mid-sensemaking Feedback Meeting.

SECTION 3: Qualities of transformation

This section is aimed at harvesting qualities or properties featuring transformative endeavours pursued through design and creativity. Participants work with emotional, embodied, strategic, inclusive, open, non-fixed, ethical, practical, and questioning qualities, highlighting the need for carving out opportunities for continuous learning. Values inspiring their outputs can be summed up as stewardship of people and the environment, empowering communities, exploring and learning, empathic engagement and promoting holistic change.
As for the qualities of practices’ impact, knowledge transfer, community empowerment, and trans-sectoral facilitation have been the most talked about. However, participants

highlighted the main concerns when embarking on triple transformation in terms of measurability, ethics, staying with ambiguity, and breaking the sectoral silos.
Each of these brings challenges and concerns since, in dynamic and highly situated contexts, it is "problematic to predefine what to measure since what is to be measured will transform along the process" (Response 21); hence, there is a call for "new ways of assessing progress and impact" (Response 23), calling for an evaluative approach that *evolves with* the transformative actions; furthermore the responsibility of transformative actions stays in ensuring that "design...includes, among others, non-humans and minorities" (Response 1), while stimulating "open-endedness, unpredictability, experimentation and imagination" (Response 28), to explore "different ways of organising (within, trans) silos" (Response 5) and engaging in "multi-actor ecosystems" (Response 18), and overcome barriers.

SECTION 4: About ecosystems

This section aims to outline the mapped ecosystem(s), looking into the nature of bodies participating in the survey and exploring their modes of collaborating and organising when embarking on systemic endeavours. The mapping activity engaged relatively evenly with the different corners of society, reflecting the systemic nature of designing for inclusive and sustainable societal transformation. As for the modes of collaboration and organisation, participants discussed such activities as processes taking "a lot of trust, daring to fail and long-term commitment" as well as patience (Response 1), in which stakeholder engagement is to be iterated and embodied in co-experiences (Response 12), to elicit synergies aiming at exchanging knowledge and nurture relationships in the long-term (Responses 28, 30); lastly, situatedness emerges as the key aspect to be handled when building long-term partnerships (Response 19).

SECTION 5: The Declaration of Interdependence

This section builds on three main questions that tap into the notions of interdependence as a lens to articulate co-construction and reciprocity. The three questions stem from previous work carried out by the research team while exploring reflections, such as: *How can I contribute to the system? What do I need from the system? What is it that I can do to have agency in the system? What am I responsible for?*

As such, they investigated three major aspects: what one is willing to gain from, contribute to, and invest in a collaborative innovation/transformation process. The questions provided responses that, once clustered, resulted in a coherent narrative about an ecosystem taking a systemic perspective on transformative endeavours. It was an opportunity to design a visualisation tool—the Declaration of Interdependence –aiming at rendering visible the multi-layered connections between available, valued, and missing assets, understood as key to working towards triple transformation in the field of culture and creativity.

The ecosystem driving triple transformation and emerging from the mapping activity seems highly committed to knowledge exchange as its main, foundational currency. However, the visualisation highlights common features and struggles of creative industries: there is practice-based knowledge, skills, and enthusiasm, although funding and resources to sustain those practices are lacking. Here, participants highlighted the need to move along inside-out and outside-in perspectives. From the inside-in point of view, the community has enough resources to work with; what is lacking and needed is to be covered from an outside-in move: "This would be important to be done in a structured way, for us all to benefit the best and to have a sense of impact from what you share". By working with frictions and re-thinking business and funding models, some reflections are invited on viable strategies and possible echo chambers, like having smaller packages supported by differentiated funding sources or connections to EIT Culture & Creativity.

SECTION 6: The community so far

The final section of the survey portrays the geographical distribution of the emerging community of practice connected to the participants of this mapping activity, which covers the global north, with a thicker concentration of engagement in Europe, which is the result of EIT Culture & Creativity's focus on Europe.

Furthermore, the mapping activity engaged with almost all the corners and sectors of society, even though the current community is slightly heavy on the academic side. This can be explained by the nature of the network supporting the research team (see Figure 15).

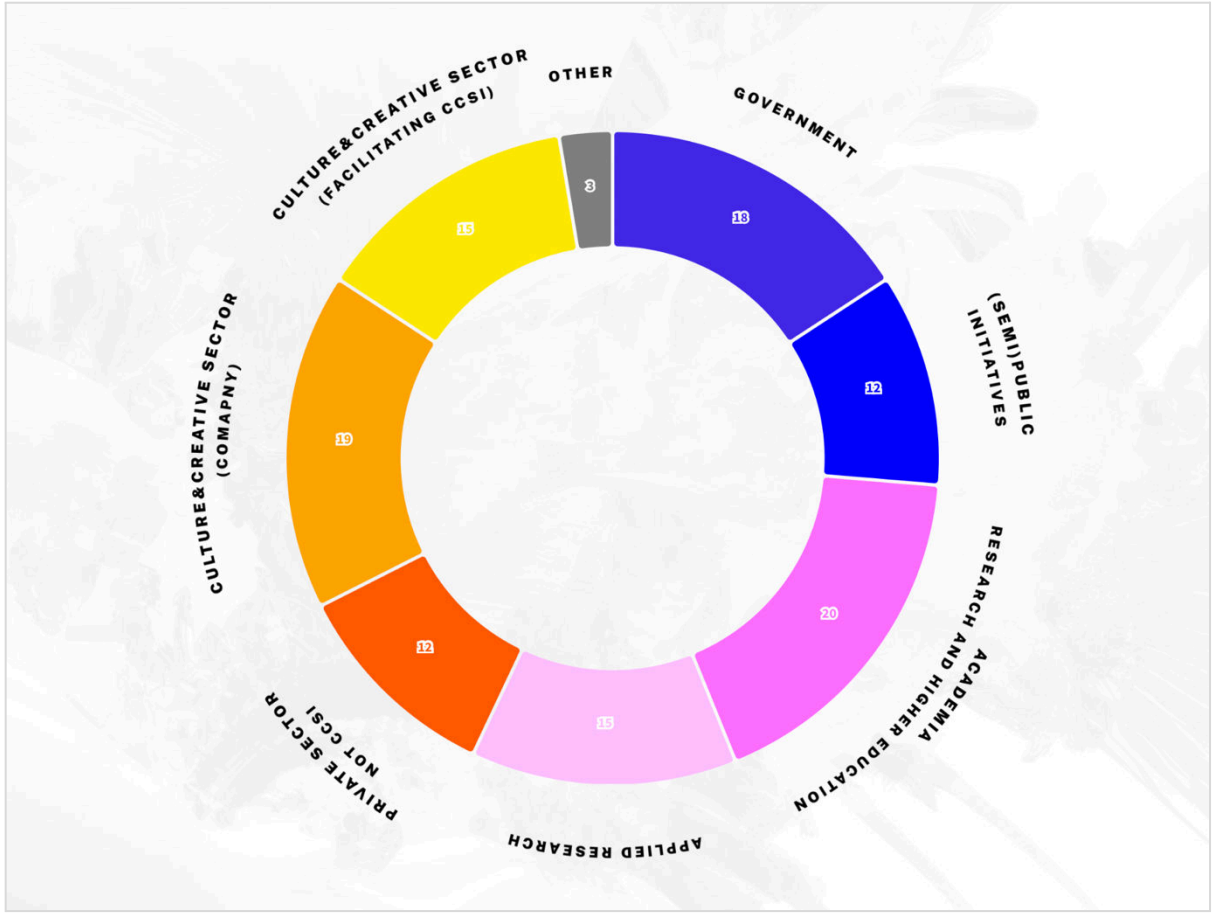


Figure 11. The different partners involved in the mapped ecosystem.

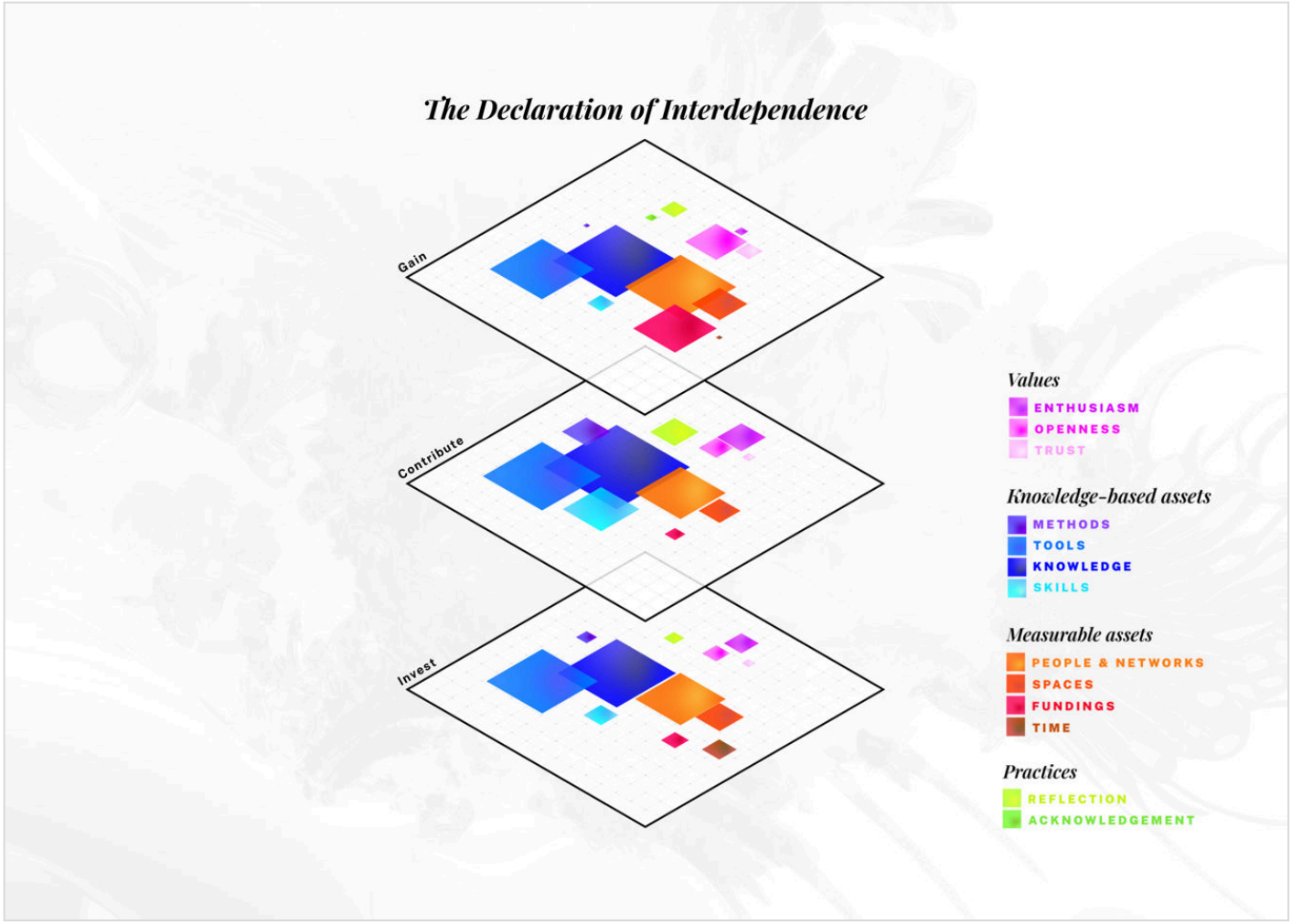


Figure 12. Visualisation of the Declaration of Interdependence.

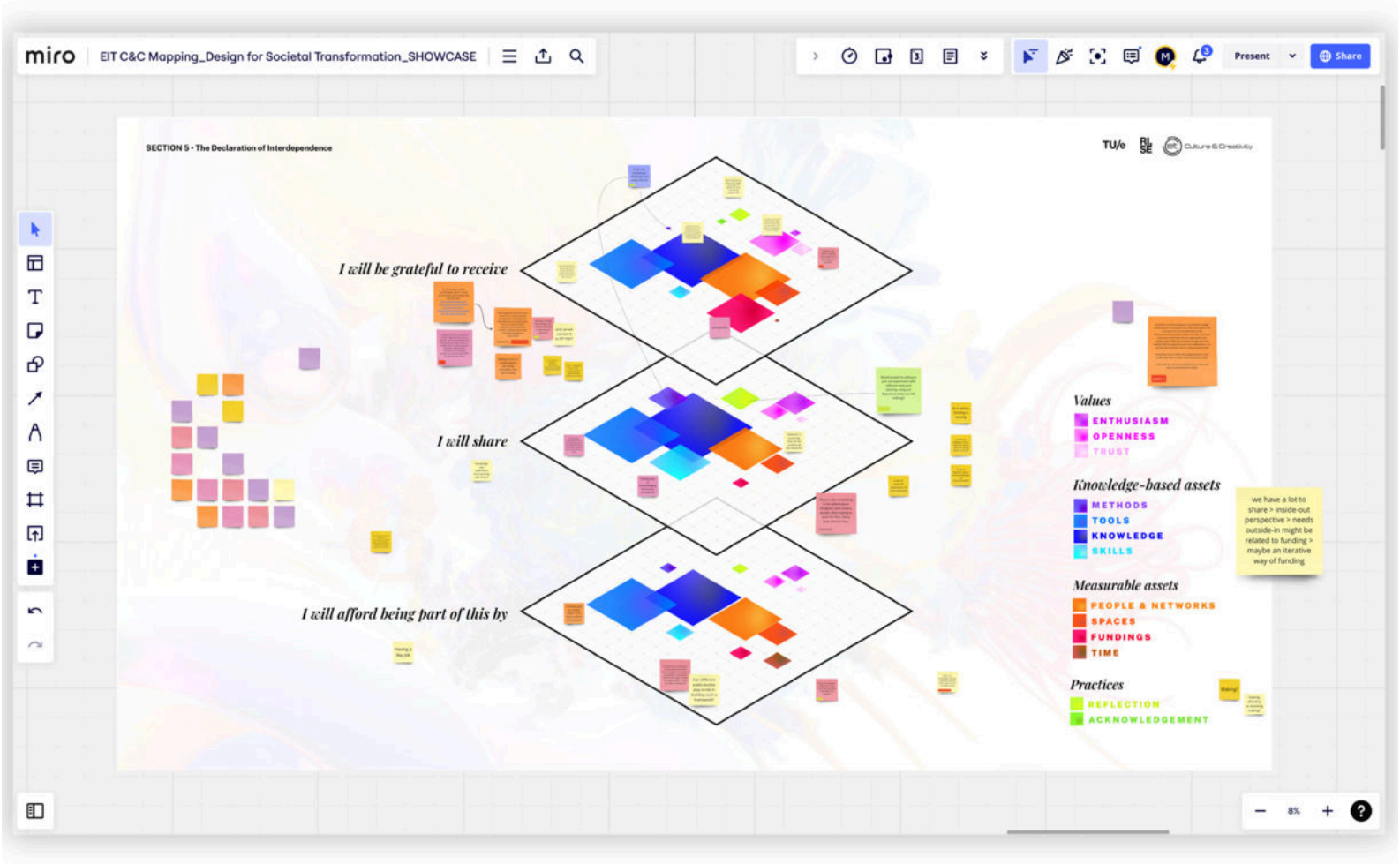


Figure 13. Screenshot from the Feedback Meeting, showing participants' inputs on the Declaration of Interdependence.

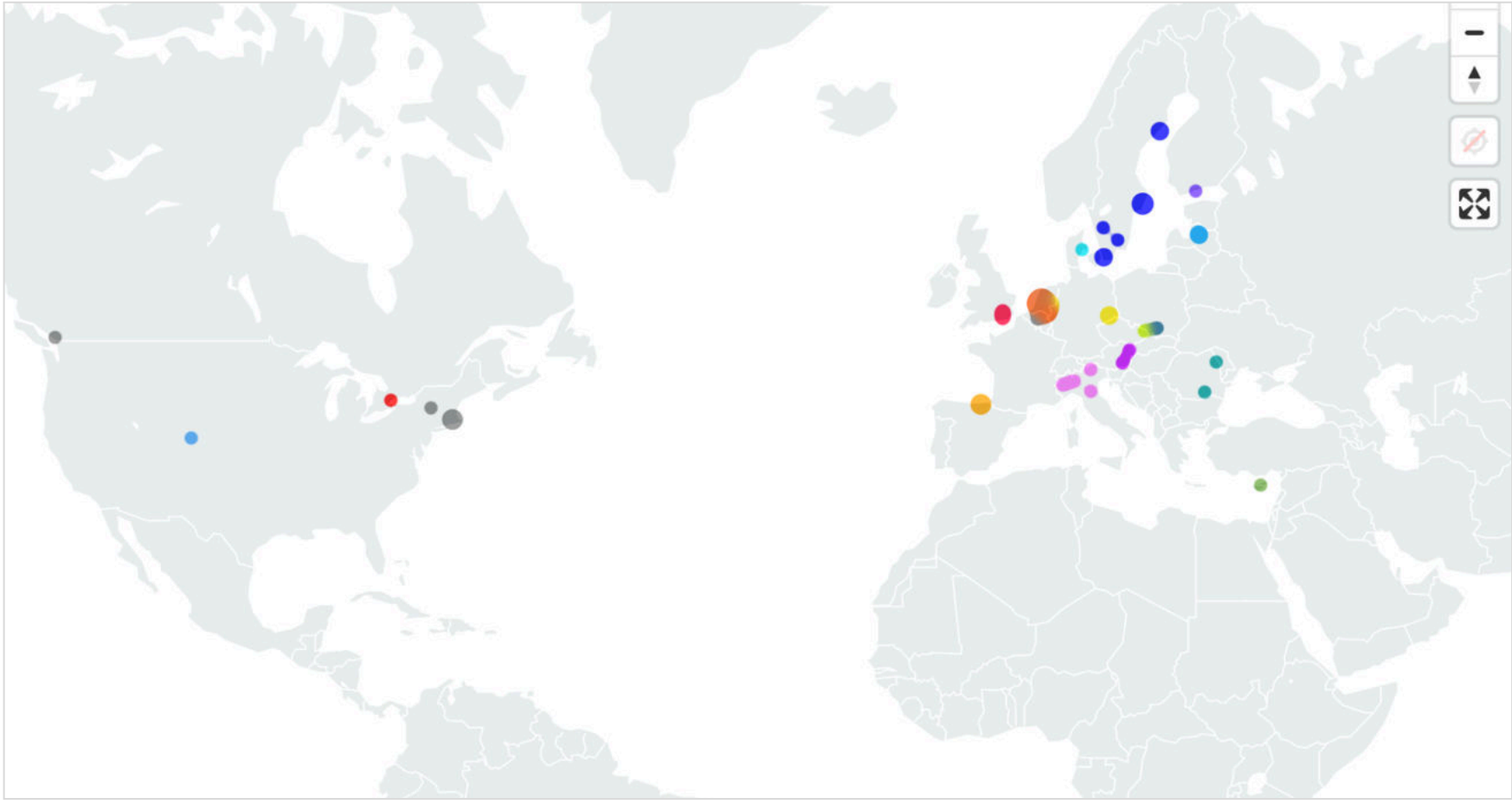


Figure 14. Geographical distribution of participants of the mapping activity.

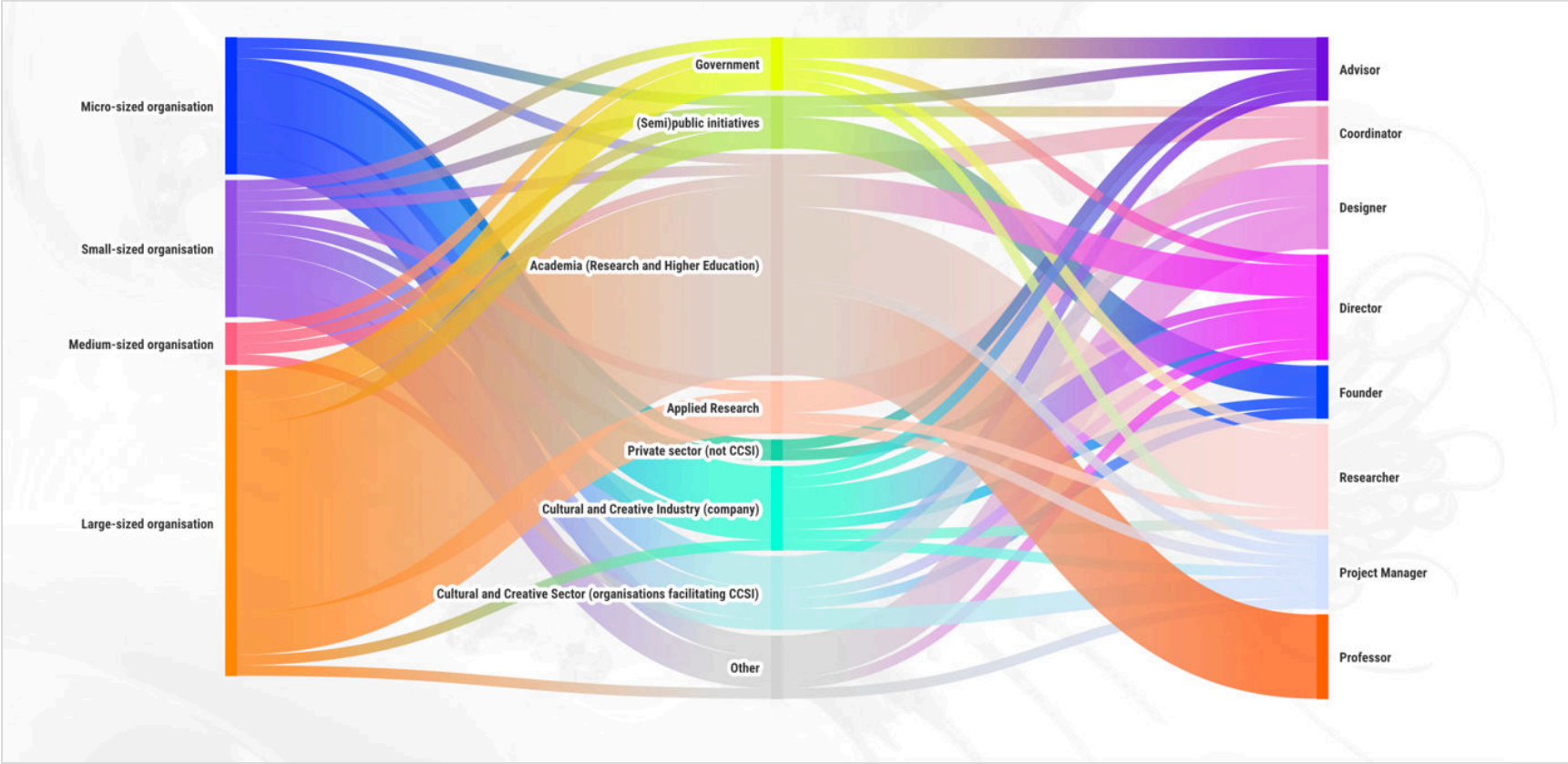


Figure 15. Alluvial diagram showing participants' role in their organisation of reference, also looking into the organisation's nature and size.

5 Formulating a set of recommendations

The knowledge resulting from the mapping activity has been formalised and prepared in a set of recommendations, which has been handed into the EIT Culture & Creativity team and used in internal processes to shape funding and innovation initiatives and their governance (e.g. the Societal Transformation Initiatives).

The set of recommendations is articulated in two main sections, giving different perspectives to approach the field of culture and creativity when working towards inclusive and sustainable societal transformation (Figure 16).



Figure 16. Set of recommendations articulated in “inside-out needs” and “outside-in actions”.

1. Inside-out *needs* were voiced by professionals, researchers, and practitioners as practices to nourish and establish. The recommendations are to:

- Cultivate value-driven processes: CCSIs are purpose-driven, and current playgrounds do not completely cater for this kind of drive; it is a community aspiring to collective growth calling for a sense of care for relationships and relationship building, paired with the need, will and commitment to invest in nourishing trusting partnerships over time.
- Pollinate trans-sectoral collaboration: Silo-ed approaches resist forms of trans-sectoral interaction, while this community of practice works in the in-between spaces to blur disciplinary boundaries and bring different expertise together. Such effort consists of facilitating discourses, creating dialogue opportunities, drafting

shared vocabularies, and focusing on collective (un)learning processes as a pivotal concern.

- Cater for emergence, experimentation, and iteration: Uncertainty and ambiguity are inherent qualities of transformation processes, calling for open-ended playgrounds inviting experimentation and iteration. Currently, there is a growing awareness of prototyping approaches. However, there are still barriers to setting the conditions for the emergence of multi-layered pathways of change that cannot be known or defined a priori but only revealed by engaging with the system.
- Provide conditions for collective reflective practices and learning: Mutual recognition, acknowledgement, and enrichment of individuals are essential to ensure collective reflective practices, which can unlock the nuances lingering in the in-between spaces when navigating trans-disciplinary contexts, leading to reframing, reorienting, and rethinking lenses for further iterations.

2. Outside-in actions, as a set of activities, actions, and practices that policymakers can support in order to provide professionals, researchers and practitioners with resources, models, and opportunities for contributing towards a sustainable societal transformation.

- Elaborate tools for shared reflection and learning: Promoting transformation literacy from a designerly perspective means having systems, enacting partnerships, and their manifested efforts being visible and readable to themselves and to outer audiences. This mapping activity attempted a portfolio of practices of transformation, which doesn't invite deeper levels of analysis. These processes rely on situated and ever-evolving nuances that hardly align with conventional projects' static anatomy - e.g., current understandings of outcomes and impact.
- Prototype alternative evaluation frameworks: New ways of understanding and evaluating outcomes and impact, when tackling societal transformation, are highly needed. Current metrics fail in grasping the set of societal and relational qualities that systemic transformation endeavours entail. Responding to emergence calls for the design of new and transformative evaluation and learning processes.
- Test multilayered funding models and policy mechanisms: Working in the landscapes of systemic transformation means accepting a degree of emergence and ambiguity in processes, which clashes with the majority of existing funding

mechanisms. The current funding practices demand a high degree of certainty to manage risk and project expectations. Design and creative approaches are particularly suited to tackle complex systemic transformation. In order to empower those who hold those competencies to operate effectively, new funding mechanisms need to be elaborated, which promote shared learning practices among partnerships, allow for work at different scales at the same time—space, time, sizes of interventions and activities, and that promote actions of integration between the different activities to foster systemic sensitivity and a shared narrative among the partners.

- Create understanding of the potential of design and creative approaches: Develop a widespread literacy on design and creative approaches is necessary for their integration into policymaking processes, stimulating transdisciplinary collaboration to engage with mission-driven innovation frameworks and inspire alternative socio-material arrangements, along with new organisational, funding, and evaluating models.

6 Reflecting: infusing mapping activities with design-supported participatory sensemaking

This mapping activity has been carried out as a collective, participated process in which collaborative moments of reflection played a pivotal role in shaping and refining the emerging narrative. The main objective was to gather knowledge about which and how design and creative practices are currently being invited to address complex systemic challenges in an inclusive and collaborative way, and, within this, to explore the role of multi- and interdisciplinary partnerships. The mapping activity is rooted in a designerly body of knowledge inspired by participatory sensemaking (Van Dijk & Hummels, 2015; Jaasma et al., 2017) to ensure that participants' inputs are correctly represented and to enable further exchange of perspectives. The mapping activity collected a set of information that would portray the values and qualities, as well as the vulnerabilities, of the culture and creativity-related sectors. As such, we carefully started the first round of sensemaking—namely clustering and highlighting key themes and focus points- with the intention of inviting participants to engage with preliminary results and start a collective reflection to co-shape the final content. In this sense, participatory sensemaking

supported us in maintaining plurality by capturing and integrating first-person perspectives through dialogic interactions. Participatory sensemaking processes happen in situations where more than two individuals interact, carrying out shared actions in shared spaces according to Sennett's (2012) framing of dialogical processes. He and Ingold (2016) articulate how sensemaking is an action-based, inter-actional, contextual activity constituted by interdependent relations with others, people and things. Sensemaking processes can, therefore, be mediated by designed artefacts that enter the discourse and provide it with a shared set of representations aiming at adding a "scaffolding layer that enhances the capacity of people to engage in a face-to-face, situated process of participatory sensemaking" (Jaasma et al., 2017). By doing so, they play a key role in activating dialogic dynamics, namely, inviting participants to take the stances of listening to, noticing (Tsing, 2015), and caring for (de laBellacasa, 2018) the matters at hand, which are preparatory to triggering collective moments of reflection and learning.

As such, we practised participatory sensemaking by designing a shared space—the Miro Board of the Feedback Meeting—to present preliminary results and by inviting participants to dive into three key outputs—the portfolio of transformation, the four processes model, and the Declaration of Interdependence.

The main elements of the design aimed at visualising connections between elements that normally are dealt with separately and whose relational nature is difficult to grasp (see Figure 12). This aesthetic intention empowered participants to better understand their individual and mutual roles and agency in complex, multistakeholder processes.

These outputs have been rendered visible and actionable to capture more detailed content, as well as aspirations and concerns on sensitive aspects. As such, the process underlying the mapping activity consisted of carving out collective moments for involved participants to gather and take action in *playgrounds,* eliciting learning not as the cognitive activity of knowing but rather as a collective practice mediated by designed artefacts in dialogical settings. Such a workflow contributed to nurturing trust among participants, who would feel co-response-able (Haraway, 2016) for the emerging narrative to be representative of their needs and means as a sector. This contributed to strengthening the loops of engagement started inside and outside the mapping activity,

providing it with a community to be further engaged to keep the conversation going and inform the next iterations.

7 Next steps: pollinating and connecting

The final set of recommendations informs policymakers and decision-makers on possible actions to be taken to support CCSIs with regards to creating the conditions to share knowledge and elicit collective, trans-disciplinary reflective practices, understood as key to trigger (un)learning processes. Given the higher presence of academic and design-related participants, the mapping activity might be reiterated to ensure a greater balance in the representation of the sector and, ultimately, to grow a more consistent database. The intention is indeed to look forward to growing as a community of practice and learning, nurturing the loops of engagement, and attracting more interest around mapping our practices in order to build a more comprehensive perspective on the multifaceted endeavours that design for inclusive and sustainable societal transformation is and might be, and what infrastructures need to be put in place to facilitate its practices.

As such, the mapping activity provides the knowledge and innovation community of the EIT Culture & Creativity with an overview of values, qualities, and frictions connected to practices enacted in the field of culture and creativity, which foster societal transformation that promotes social cohesion and environmental resilience. This mapping can furthermore inform, inspire, and connect to the broad global CCSI community and its activities.

A growing number of programs, projects, and initiatives capitalise on design and creative approaches to foster systemic transformation. Such wealth proves the urgency of these matters (e.g., ongoing studies such as Wahl, 2016; Escobar, 2018; Irwin, Tonkinwise, & Kossoff, 2022; Huybrechts & Tassinari, 2022 and research projects, such as Dolejšová et al., 2021; Mortati et al., 2023; Vervoort et al., 2024).

Ultimately, this mapping activity provides a lens that contributes to wider strands of sensemaking processes, possibly contributing to a “transformation agenda” that collects and operationalises pathways of transition towards more inclusive and sustainable futures.

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